

MATH

Mental Math Strategies

A quick-reference sheet of the mental math strategies we practice in class to build number sense.

These are the mental math strategies we practice regularly to build number sense and speed without relying only on paper-and-pencil methods.

Friendly Numbers (Compensation)

Round one number to a friendly number, then adjust the answer.

Example: $38 + 47 \rightarrow 40 + 47 = 87$, then subtract 2 (because we added 2 extra) = 85

Doubling & Halving

For multiplication, double one factor and halve the other — the product stays the same.

Example: $16 \times 5 \rightarrow 8 \times 10 = 80$

Breaking Apart (Decomposing)

Split a number into tens and ones, solve each part, then add them back together.

Example: $7 \times 23 \rightarrow (7 \times 20) + (7 \times 3) = 140 + 21 = 161$

Using Known Facts

Use a fact you already know to figure out a related one.

Example: If you know $5 \times 6 = 30$, then $6 \times 6 = 30 + 6 = 36$